

DOES THIS SECTION EVEN NEED AN INTRODUCTION? FROM COMPUTERS TO MOBILES, AND HEADPHONES TO GPUs, IT'S ALL HERE...

THIS MONTH IN TECH: Learn esoteric Excel tricks to up your game. We also review the latest 12th Gen Intel processors and Agent001 wonders if the upgrade to DDR5 is worth it or not?



YouTube is restricting access to music videos

Before truckloads of content creators took over the platform, YouTube was a space to watch music videos and listen to your favourite tunes. Now, YouTube has announced that it won't allow non-members to watch music videos. [digit.in/ytmusicvideos](https://www.digit.in/ytmusicvideos)

WHAT'S NEW

The Facebook Company goes Meta

The Facebook Company has been rebranded and will be known as Meta going forward. CEO Mark Zuckerberg announced the rebrand at Connect 2021 and the company is now aiming to build the Metaverse which is described as "a hybrid of today's online social experiences, sometimes expanded into three dimensions or projected into the physical world." The company encapsulated social media services including Facebook, Messenger, WhatsApp, Instagram and Oculus. Going forward, these services will fall under Meta but the rebrand does not affect how they will function. Mark Zuckerberg also announced a \$50 million investment in global research and

program partners to ensure the Metaverse products are developed responsibly. Bloomberg reports that the company is developing a smartwatch and even posted an image tipped to be of the device. The report notes that the



image was found within the company's Facebook View

app that will help control the new smart glasses it plans to develop in partnership with Ray-Ban. Meta also announced that Oculus Quest will now be rebranded as Meta Quest, and the Oculus App will now be called Meta Quest App. [digit.in/meta](https://www.digit.in/meta)

Stable Android 12 build released by Google

Android 12 was announced during I/O 2021, however, it's been a while since then and we've only seen a few work-in-progress updates so far. If you've been waiting for the update though, here's some good news – Google has finally announced the release of Android 12. The Android 12 build has been released for the Android Open



Source Project. Google Pixel phones, on the other hand, are yet to receive the update, and it isn't clear when that'll be. Android 12 will be released to Google Pixel phones like the Google Pixel 3, Pixel 3A, Pixel 4, Pixel 4A, Pixel 4A 5G, Pixel 5, and Pixel 5A smartphones. Additionally, Google's newer offerings, the Google Pixel 6 and Pixel 6 Pro

will have the new Android 12 preinstalled out of the box. A host of other brands such as Samsung, OnePlus, Oppo, Xiaomi, Realme, Tecno, and Vivo have revealed that their newer offerings will come with the Android 12 OS in 2021. One of the biggest differences to note in the Android 12 OS is the implementation of the Material You design in all its apps and overall aesthetic. [digit.in/android12](https://www.digit.in/android12)



Intel unveils 12th Gen Core Alder Lake hybrid desktop lineup

Intel announced their 12th Gen Alder Lake hybrid desktop processors during their Intel Innovation virtual event. They are built using the Intel 7 process (previously known as Intel 10nm Enhanced Super Fin process). [digit.in/intel12thgen](https://www.digit.in/intel12thgen)



Apple launches Safari 15.1 for macOS Big Sur and Catalina

With the release of macOS Monterey, Apple reverted to a more classic design for the Safari browser. Now, the company has made the update available to those running macOS Big Sur and Catalina with Safari 15.1. [digit.in/newsafari](https://www.digit.in/newsafari)



Zoom to offer new Live Captioning feature

The popular video conferencing app Zoom, has begun rolling out an update that brings live captioning during video calls. These captions will be auto-generated, and will also be available on Zoom Paid and Zoom Webinar accounts. [digit.in/zoomcaptions](https://www.digit.in/zoomcaptions)